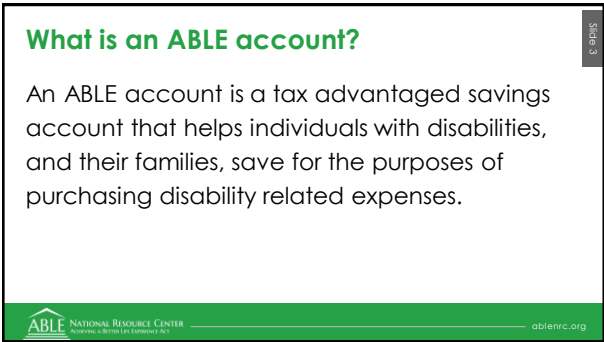








Slide 4

How do funds in an ABE account affect my benefits?

Funds in an ABE account will not be taken into consideration when determining an individual's eligibility for means test public benefits (including Supplemental Security Income (SSI) and Medicaid)

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Slide 5

Why the need for an ABE account?

Millions of individuals with disabilities and their families depend on a wide variety of public benefits for income, healthcare and food and housing assistance. Eligibility for these public benefits (SSI, SNAP, Medicaid) require meeting a means or resource test that limits eligibility to individuals to report more than \$2,000 in cash savings, retirement funds and other items of significant value. To remain eligible for these public benefits, an individual must remain poor.

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Slide 6

Who is eligible to be an ABE account beneficiary?

To be eligible, individuals must meet two requirements:

- 1) Age requirement: must be disabled before age 26
- 2) Severity of disability:
 - Have been determined to meet the disability requirements for Supplemental Security Income (SSI) or Social Security disability benefits (Title XVI or Title II of the Social Security Act) and are receiving those benefits.

OR

- Submit a "disability certification" assuring that the individual holds documentation of a physician's diagnosis and signature, and confirming that the individual meets the functional disability criteria in the ABE Act (related to the severity of disability described in Title XVI or Title II of the Social Security Act)*.

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Slide 7

Do I have to enroll in my state of residence?

No. Regardless of where you might live and whether or not your state has decided to establish an ABLE program, you are free to enroll in any state's program provided that the program is accepting out of state residents.

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Slide 8

Are there limits on account contributions?

The total annual contributions by all participating individuals, including family and friends, for a single tax year is \$14,000. This amount may be adjusted periodically to account for inflation. The total account limit over time will be subject to the individual state and their limit for education-related 529 savings accounts. Many states have set this limit at more than \$300,000 per plan.

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Slide 9

What may funds from an ABLE account be used for?

- Distributions from an ABLE account may be made for "qualified disability expenses".
- "Qualified disability expenses" are expenses that relate to the designated beneficiary's blindness or disability and are for the benefit of that designated beneficiary in maintaining or improving his or her health, independence, or quality of life.
- The term "qualified disability expenses" should be broadly construed to permit the inclusion of basic living expenses and should not be limited to:
 - expenses for items for which there is a medical necessity, or
 - which provide no benefits to others in addition to the benefit to the eligible individual.

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Slide 10

Qualified disability expenses may include the following:

- Education
- Housing
- Transportation
- Employment training and support
- Assistive technology and personal support services
- Health, prevention, and wellness
- Financial management and administrative services
- Legal fees
- Expenses for oversight and monitoring
- Basic Living Expenses (NPRM)
- Funeral and burial expenses
- Any other expenses approved by the Secretary of the Treasury under regulations consistent with the purpose of the program

Distributions for non-qualified expenditures will be subject to tax consequences and may affect eligibility for federal means tested benefits.

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Slide 11

Where will I have to go to open an account?

Currently there are 18 states that have launched ABLE programs. With the exception of Florida and Kentucky, all the currently launched states are enrolling nationwide. Enrollment and maintenance of the account is currently done entirely online.

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Slide 12

Individual Plans

- Youth in Transition Individual Education Plan (IEP)
- VR Individual Employment Plan (IPE)
- HCBS Individual Support Plan

1. Include objective to create and ABLE account
2. Set short and long term financial goals
3. Set objectives to improve financial literacy

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Side 13

Tool for Financial Stability and Competitive Integrated Employment Outcomes

Qualified Disability Expenses

1. Transportation to and from work
2. Benefits planning and counseling
3. Medicaid Buy-In program premiums
4. Job coaching
5. Personal assistant services
6. Computer, smart phone, assistive technology
7. Financial planning and counseling

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Where can I go to find further ABLE related information?

- **The ABLE National Resource Center** (ANRC) is a collaborative whose supporters share the goal of accelerating the design and availability of ABLE accounts for the benefit of individuals with disabilities and their families. We bring together the investment, support and resources of the country's largest and most influential national disability organizations.

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